Model: CAMILA / OPAL MODELS *Makeup & Hair*: KHUSHI JANGID



admit to doing so compared to 17 per cent men. More men (73 per cent) believe their partner would be interested in discussing their sexual needs than women (65 per cent). Also, more men (67 per cent) say they share their fantasies with their partners than women (63 per cent). Women, on the other hand, appear more experimental—a larger number say they have tried out oral and anal sex than men. However, when asked if they think there is a gap between male and female pleasure, one-fifth of the respondents say they aren't sure, 36 per cent agree there is a gap and 44 per cent say there isn't. The responses are pretty much the same across sex and age groups. However, among the respondents who are separated or divorced, more than half agree to a pleasure gap between men and women.

Bad sex is often accepted as the norm in a relationship because many don't know any better. "When I was married, I suspected our sex life was poor but could never figure out what was wrong. My body had a certain set of needs I wasn't even aware of," says 42-year-old Sudeshna Bose (*name changed*), a homemaker from Kolkata. "Now that I am divorced and dating again, I see how much I was missing out. I actually don't want to get tied down if it means sacrificing my own happiness to feed a male ego." The first she heard of female masturbation, says Basu, was at age 38 when she saw the Netflix show *Lust Stories*. "It was a huge eye-opener." Looking back, Basu realises, sex played an equal part in the breakdown of her marriage as the lack of communication. She recalls that she mostly played a passive role in the entire act and could not even beg off if she

THE SEXUAL WELLNESS MARKET IN INDIA HAS EXPLODED IN SERVICE OF THE FEMALE CONSUMER

